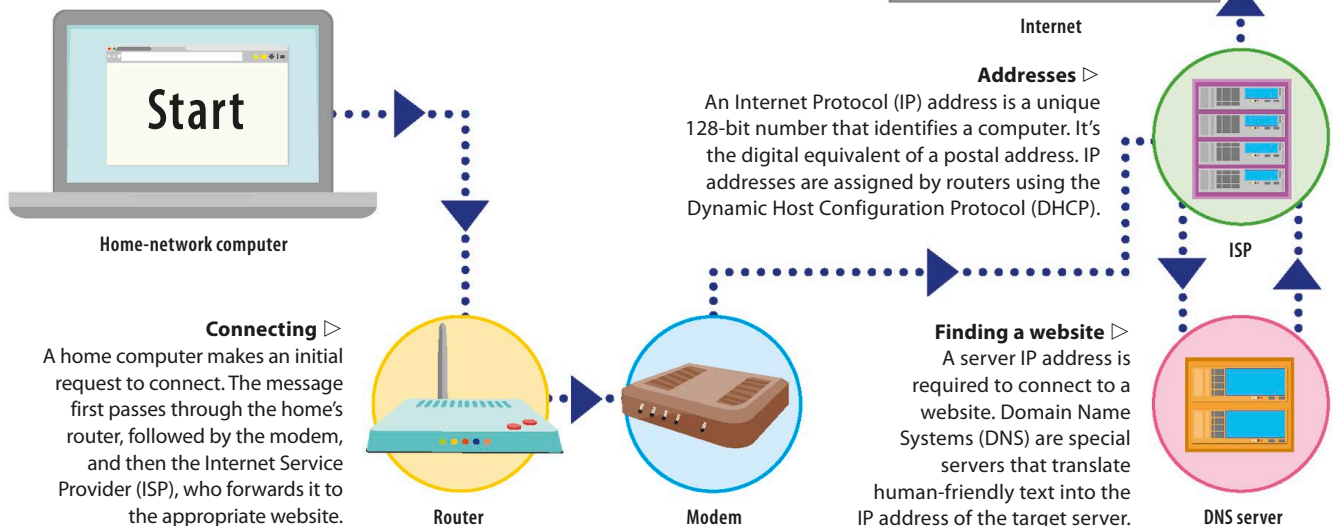


Connections

Many steps are involved in connecting to a website and exchanging data. The process is the same whether the two devices are next to each other, or continents apart.

Connecting to a website

Each digital communication involves a request from the client, and a response from the server. The format and content of each message is determined by the communications protocol, which is agreed upon by the devices used in advance. HTTP is the best-known protocol and the most commonly used over the internet.



SEE ALSO

◀ 144–145 What is a network?

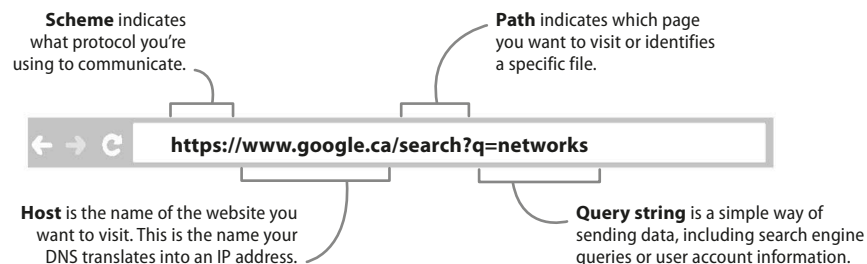
◀ 146–147 Types of network

The internet and the world wide web

150–151 ▶

URLs

URL (Uniform Resource Locator), also known as a web address, is a standardized system for locating and identifying content on the world wide web. Each URL can be broken down into four distinct parts. Here's an example you might see in your web browser if you search for "networks" on Google:



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Other protocols

File Transfer Protocol (FTP) is used when uploading and downloading files, and Simple Mail Transfer Protocol (SMTP) plays a role in regulating emails. NoiseSocket is used by WhatsApp to create secure connections, while Real-time Transport Protocol (RTP) and Real-time Streaming Protocol (RTSP) are used for multimedia.